Service Desk and Ticket Handling Standard

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1. How to Get Help

- Service portal: help.kestrel.example, the fastest route for most requests.
- Microsoft Teams: the "IT Help" chat.
- Phone: ext. 4357 (H-E-L-P), recommended for P1 issues.
- Walk-up desks in the Bengaluru and Pune offices, 10:00 to 17:00 on weekdays.

The Service Desk is staffed from 08:00 to 20:00 IST, Monday to Friday. P1 incidents are handled 24x7 through the phone line.

2. Ticket Priorities and SLAs

- P1 Critical (a company-wide outage, a security incident in progress, or a lost or stolen device): first response within 15 minutes and a resolution target of 4 hours, 24x7.
- P2 High (a team or a business-critical process is blocked): first response within 1 hour and a resolution target of 8 business hours.
- P3 Normal (one person is affected and a workaround exists): first response within 4 business hours and a resolution target of 3 business days.
- P4 Low (service requests and questions): first response within 1 business day and a resolution target of 10 business days.

The Service Desk may change the priority you choose if it does not match these definitions.

3. Ticket Categories

Choose the closest category so the ticket reaches the right team: Account and Password, Access Request, Hardware, Software, Network/VPN, Email and Collaboration, or Security Incident. Security Incident tickets go straight to the Security Operations team and are always handled as P1 or P2.

4. Escalation

A ticket that breaches its SLA is escalated automatically to the Service Desk Lead, and after twice the SLA time to the IT Operations Manager. You can also ask for an escalation yourself by replying to the ticket with the word "escalate" and a reason.

5. Resolving and Closing Tickets

When an agent marks your ticket Resolved, you receive an email. If you do not reply, the ticket closes automatically after 5 business days; replying within that window reopens it. Once a ticket is closed, raise a new ticket and quote the old ticket number.

6. What to Include in a Ticket

Include your device name (shown in Company Portal), the exact error message or code, when the problem started, what you have already tried, and a screenshot if you can. Never put passwords or MFA codes in a ticket.